INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Market Planning

SPORTS AND ENTERTAINMENT MARKETING
TEAM DECISION MAKING EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the concept of market and market identification.
2. Identify ways to segment markets for marketing communications.
3. Describe the nature of target marketing in marketing communications.
4. Describe the nature of product bundling.
5. Identify communications channels used in sales promotion.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the roles of the marketing manager and the ticket sales manager for the RIVER CITY ROCKHOUNDS, a minor league baseball team. The general manager (judge) wants your team to identify new markets for the team and plan how to reach them.

The ROCKHOUNDS play 70 home games a season in a 6,500-seat ballpark in downtown River City. Last season the team averaged 3,100 fans per game, which is less than half of capacity. Most of the team's loyal fans are older: 62% of season ticket holders are over age 50. Group sales to local businesses and youth leagues dropped 18% last season.

A fan survey and a survey of River City residents found that:

- Residents ages 22 to 34 said ticket prices were reasonable but described games as "something my parents do." They said they'd come for a social night out with friends.
- Families with young children said weeknight games end too late but that weekend afternoon games fit their schedules.
- Over 40% of residents said they had never been to a ROCKHOUNDS game.

The general manager (judge) wants your team to:

- Explain the team's current market and identify new markets the ROCKHOUNDS could attract.
- Explain how to segment the market and target the right messages to each segment.
- Recommend ticket bundles that would appeal to the new target markets.
- Identify the communications channels the team should use to promote the bundles.

You will present your ideas to the general manager (judge) in a meeting in the general manager's office. The general manager (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and answered the general manager's (judge's) questions, the general manager (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. What should go into a bundle to make it worth more than buying each item separately?
2. Which promotion channel will give us the best results for the least money?

Rate the participants' ability to:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the concept of market and market identification.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Identify ways to segment markets for marketing communications.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Describe the nature of target marketing in marketing communications.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Describe the nature of product bundling.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Identify communications channels used in sales promotion.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
9.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
12.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	